Rikuto Onishi

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Department of Economics, The University of Texas at Austin
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Education

The University of Texas at Austin 2021–2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Economics

Keio University – Japan 2018–2020
M.A. in Economics

Keio University – Japan 2014–2018
B.A. in Economics

References

Olivier Coibion (Co-chair)
Malcolm Forsman Centennial Professor
Department of Economics
The University of Texas at Austin
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Stefano Eusepi (Co-chair)
Professor of Economics
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Christoph Boehm
Associate Professor
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Job Market Paper

"Exchange Rate Disconnect with Disagreeing Arbitrageurs"

Abstract: I build a two-country general equilibrium model in which international arbitrageurs disagree about future exchange rates. Trading gains and losses redistribute wealth among the arbitrageurs, so the set of arbitrageurs whose beliefs determine the equilibrium price changes. This mechanism amplifies the exchange rate response to a standard macro shock and generates an endogenous wedge in uncovered interest parity without the need for a separate financial shock. The model is calibrated to macro, financial, and survey data and can reproduce the high exchange rate volatility and the weak relationship between exchange rates and underlying fundamentals. The calibrated disagreement-wealth multiplier implies that the amplification accounts for about 62% of the exchange rate standard deviation.

Work in Progress

"Stock Market Uncertainty and Firm Matching"
with Husang Kim and Kai Wu

Uses the universe of Chinese VAT invoices and exploits the 2015 stock market turbulence as a natural experiment. Documents a contraction in B2B transactions for firms more exposed to stock market uncertainty. Develops a frictional matching model with stock prices as noisy signals.

"Disagreement, Monetary Policy, and Term Premia"
with Stefano Eusepi and Bruce Preston

Develops a New Keynesian model with heterogeneous beliefs and short/long bonds. Explores stability and determinacy in the presence of heterogeneous beliefs and aims to capture time-varying term premia.

"Using Exchange Rate Variation for Estimation"
with Christoph Boehm and Husang Kim

Pre-Ph.D. Publication

"Sample Sensitivity for Two-Step and Continuous Updating GMM Estimators"
with Taisuke Otsu. *Economics Letters* (2021).

Research Experience

Research Assistant 2024–2026
Professor Christoph Boehm

Research Assistant 2025
Professor Oliver Pfäuti

Research Assistant 2023
Professor Stefano Eusepi

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, The University of Texas at Austin

Course	**Instructor**	**Semester**
Macroeconomics (M.A.; ECO 394L)	Sahil Ravgotra	Fall 2026
Computational Economics (ECO 363C)	Oliver Pfäuti	Spring 2024
Macroeconomic Theory (ECO 320L)	Stefano Eusepi	Fall 2023
Macroeconomic Theory (ECO 320L)	Christoph Boehm	Spring 2023
Advanced Microeconomics (ECO 420S)	Svetlana Boyarchenko	Fall 2022
Macroeconomic Theory (ECO 320L)	Brian Trinque	Spring 2022
Introduction to Microeconomics (ECO 304K)	G. Dirk Mateer; Charity-Joy Acchiardo	Fall 2021

Fellowships, Awards, and Professional Experience

Thomas J. Sargent Dissertation Fellowship, Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco	2026
MFR Program Summer Session for Young Scholars (Invited attendee)	2026
UT Austin Summer Research Fellowship	2024, 2025, 2026
Dissertation Internship, Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland	2025
Summer Internship, International Monetary Fund	2024
NBER Behavioral Macro Bootcamp (Invited attendee)	2024
Visiting Researcher, Keio University	2023
Best Second-Year Paper Award	2023
JASSO Scholarship for Graduate Studies	2023–2026
Graduate Fellowship (UT Austin)	2021–Present
Japan-IMF Scholarship Program for Advanced Studies	2021–2023

Presentations

Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco (x2), MFR Program Summer Session for Young Scholars at University of Chicago (poster), Texas Macro Job Candidate Conference at Texas A&M University	2026
Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland, UT Austin, Waseda University	2025

Skills and Interests

Research interests: Macroeconomics, International Macro and Finance, Monetary Policy, Expectations Formation, Behavioral Macro

Languages: English (fluent), Japanese (native), Chinese-Mandarin (beginner)

Citizenship: Japanese citizen, F1 visa